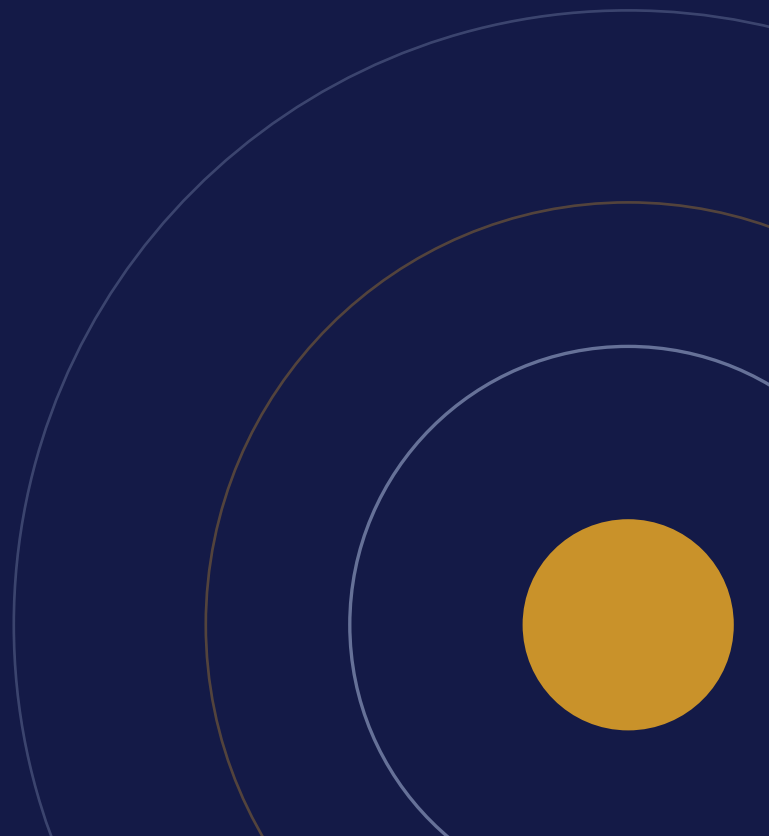


RESEARCH DIVISION

Research Excellence Framework

REF

A Structured Research Mentorship Programme



Why a Research Excellence Framework?

The need for a structured research framework

Research is an essential component of higher education, yet many students struggle to initiate and complete meaningful research due to a lack of guidance, structured planning, and practical exposure.

While students may possess curiosity and academic potential, they often face difficulty selecting research topics, reviewing literature, designing methodologies, analysing data, and publishing their work.

REF addresses these challenges through a structured, mentor-led pathway that supports students across the complete research lifecycle.

Common Research Challenges

- ❓ Selecting a feasible topic
- ❓ Reviewing academic literature
- ❓ Designing sound methodology
- ❓ Analysing research data
- ❓ Publishing scholarly work

What Is the Research Excellence Framework?

REF is a structured mentorship programme that guides students through every stage of the research process — combining systematic learning, practical assignments, continuous mentorship, and measurable outcomes to build independent research competence. Rather than focusing solely on producing a paper, REF cultivates critical thinking, academic integrity, analytical ability, and scientific communication.

Key Features

1

**Structured Learning
Pathway**

A logical,
stage-by-stage
curriculum

2

Expert Mentorship

Continuous
one-to-one faculty
guidance

3

**Practical Research
Activities**

Hands-on
assignments at every
stage

4

AI-Assisted Learning

Modern research and
writing tools

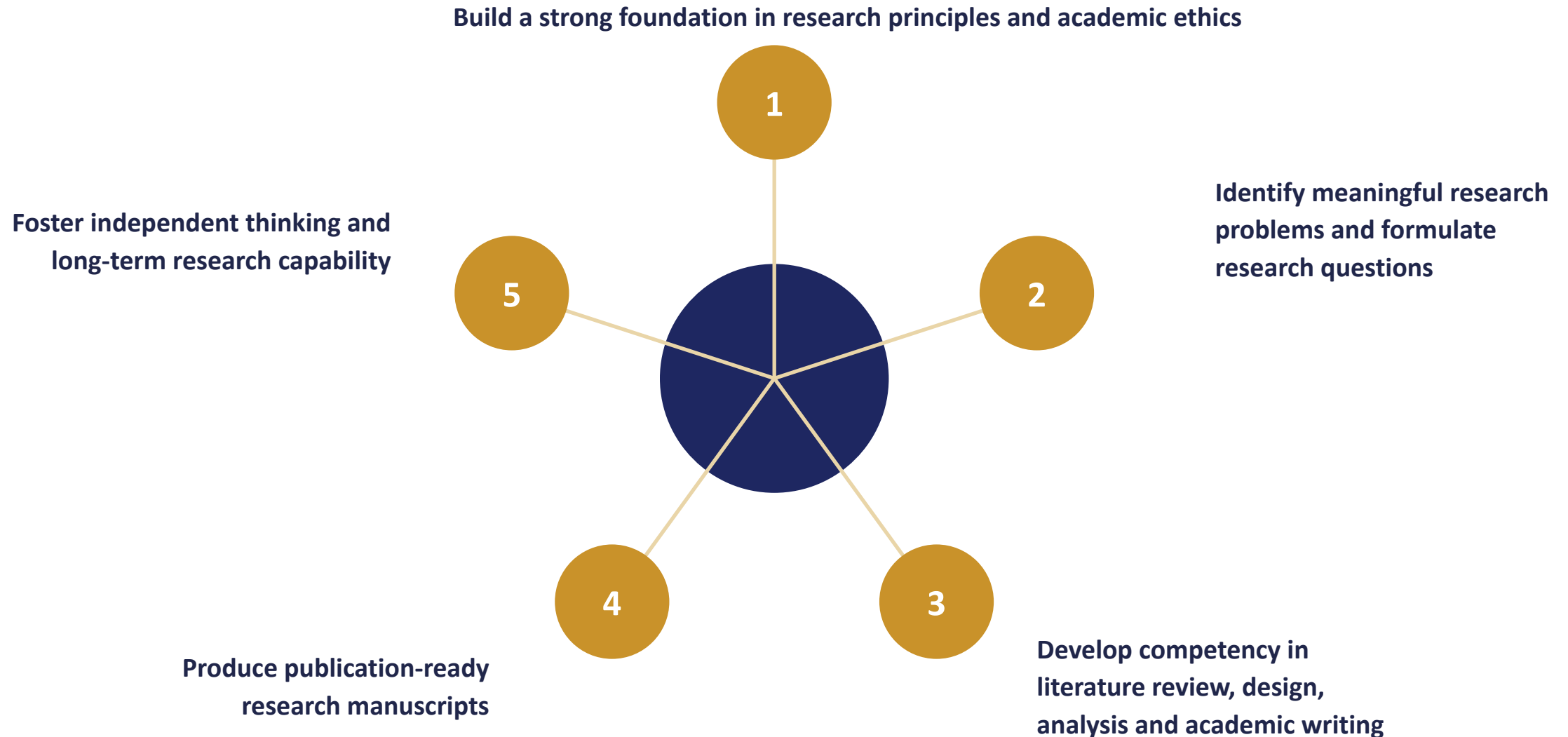
5

**Publication-Oriented
Outcomes**

Built toward a real
manuscript

Objectives of REF 5 Core Objectives

Five pillars that shape every stage of the programme



Expected Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of the programme, students will be able to:



**Understand and critically evaluate
scholarly literature**



**Identify research gaps and formulate
research questions**



**Design appropriate research
methodologies**



**Collect, analyse, and interpret
research data**



**Write publication-ready research
papers**



**Present research through journals,
conferences, and academic portfolios**

The REF Journey

A structured seven-stage progression toward a publication-ready manuscript



Every stage builds upon the previous one — a logical, comprehensive research journey.



Stage 1 of 7

Research Foundations

Building the Foundation for Research Excellence

Students develop the essential knowledge, skills, and academic mindset required to conduct high-quality research — establishing the base for every subsequent stage.

Key Learning Areas

- Research process and research types
- Academic ethics and integrity
- Literature search techniques
- Critical reading of research papers
- Reference management (Zotero, Mendeley)
- AI tools for research (ChatGPT, Elicit, Consensus, NotebookLM)

Deliverables

- Research Reflection Exercise
- Literature Library
- Annotated Paper Reviews
- AI Research Toolkit

OUTCOME: Research-Ready Student

2

Stage 2 of 7

Research Exploration & Proposal Development

Transforming Ideas into Research Questions

Through guided mentorship, students refine areas of interest into feasible topics, identify research gaps, and build the proposal that blueprints their project.

Key Learning Areas

- Research interest mapping
- Topic selection and refinement
- Preliminary literature exploration
- Research gap identification
- Research questions and objectives
- Proposal writing

Deliverables

- Research Interest Sheet
- Research Gap Statement
- Research Questions Document
- Complete Research Proposal

OUTCOME: Proposal-Ready Researcher

3

Stage 3 of 7

Literature Review & Gap Identification

Building the Theoretical Foundation

Students search, evaluate, organise, and critically analyse scholarly literature to establish a robust theoretical and conceptual framework.

Key Learning Areas

- Literature search strategies
- Evaluating scholarly sources
- Literature matrices
- Critical literature review
- Research gap identification
- Conceptual framework development

Deliverables

- Literature Search Log
- Source Evaluation Matrix
- Literature Review Matrix
- Draft Literature Review
- Conceptual Framework

OUTCOME: Comprehensive Literature Review Completed



Stage 4 of 7

Research Design & Methodology

Designing a Scientifically Sound Research Plan

Students transform their proposal into a structured methodology — selecting research designs, sampling techniques, instruments, and ethical practices.

Key Learning Areas

- Research design
- Qualitative, quantitative & mixed methods
- Sampling techniques
- Questionnaire / interview design
- Research ethics
- Methodology writing

Deliverables

- Research Design Document
- Sampling Plan
- Research Instruments
- Complete Methodology Chapter

5

Stage 5 of 7

Data Collection & Analysis

Converting Evidence into Meaningful Insights

Students collect, organise, analyse, and interpret data using qualitative and quantitative techniques, presenting findings through tables and graphs.

Key Learning Areas

- Data collection
- Data preparation and cleaning
- Quantitative & qualitative analysis
- Statistical software
- Interpretation of findings
- Visual presentation of results

Deliverables

- Research Dataset
- Analysis Outputs
- Findings Summary
- Results Chapter

OUTCOME: Evidence Generated



Stage 6 of 7

Academic Writing & Manuscript Development

Communicating Research Effectively

Students integrate every component of their research into a clear, coherent, publication-ready paper following academic writing standards and journal guidelines.

Key Learning Areas

- Research paper structure (IMRaD)
- Academic writing
- Citation and referencing
- Editing and peer review
- Formatting for journals
- Final manuscript preparation

Deliverables

- Complete Research Manuscript
- Revised Draft
- Reference List
- Publication-Ready Paper

OUTCOME: Publication-Ready Manuscript



Stage 7 of 7

Publication & Research Communication

Sharing Research with the Academic Community

Students learn to select suitable journals, prepare submissions, present their work confidently, and build a strong academic portfolio for future opportunities.

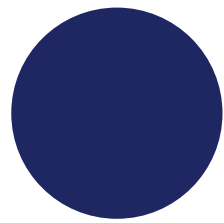
Key Learning Areas

- Journal selection
- Manuscript submission
- Conference presentations
- Research posters
- Academic networking
- Research portfolio development

Deliverables

- Journal Submission
- Conference Presentation
- Research Portfolio
- Publication Strategy

OUTCOME: Published Research Outcome



THANK YOU

